

# 119 Deciding and hedging

English uses a number of words and phrases to discuss the different sides of an argument or to make sentences sound less definite.

**See also:**

Infinitives and participles **51** More linking words **112** Making conversation **120**

## 119.1 DISCUSSING ARGUMENTS

There are specific words and phrases which are used to discuss or compare the good and bad sides of an argument.



I'm not sure whether to go to the party tonight.

On the one hand, I'd have a great time.  
On the other hand, I have work to do.

## FURTHER EXAMPLES

**Although** my friends will be at the party, I don't want to stay up late.



I could go to the party. **Alternatively** I could stay in and study.



**Of course**, there is going to be good music and lots of food.



I don't want to study Art. **However**, my teacher thinks I'm good at it.



**Despite** my reservations, I think I'll go to the party anyway.

